

TECHNICAL COMMUNICATION

A major or minor in Technical Communication can open new career paths in business, science, and industry. Some students in technical or scientific fields enhance their degree by adding a major or minor in Technical Communication. Technical Communication is also an additional major or minor for students who major in English (<http://catalog.iastate.edu/collegeofliberalartsandsciences/english/>), linguistics, or other humanities and social science disciplines.

BS in Technical Communication Learning Outcomes

Students who major in Technical Communication will be able to

- Compose a wide range of print and online documents for use in business, science, industry, schools, and communities.
- Identify specific audience needs in rapidly changing digital and print environments.
- Identify and create user-friendly interfaces; understand and put into practice strategies to enable the optimal usability of documents.
- Demonstrate mastery of concepts from organizational culture and visual communication, including collaborative writing and clear, responsive professional and technical documents.
- Understand technical and scientific information and strategies for writing and designing texts to communicate that information to others.
- Describe and use the theories that assess print and online documents, collaboration, organizational activities, and various technologies.

Technical Communication Major Requirements

Majors develop advanced skills in multiple aspects of technical communication and apply their knowledge of technical communication to a specific discipline. Technical Communication majors must take 33 credits within the major and 6 hours in a Designated Area of Concentration related to science, technology, or design (an acceptable minor will also fulfill this requirement).

ENGL 2140	Introduction to Technical Communication	3
ENGL 3100	Rhetorical Analysis	3
ENGL 3130	Rhetorical Website Design	3
ENGL 3140	Technical Communication	3
ENGL 4150	Business and Technical Editing	3
ENGL 4160	Visual Aspects of Business and Technical Communication	3

Electives: 9 credits (with at least 6 credits from 4000 or above courses) 9

ENGL 2200	Descriptive English Grammar
ENGL 2220	Artificial Intelligence and Writing
ENGL 3020	Business Communication
ENGL 3090	Proposal and Report Writing
ENGL 3120	Communicating Science and Public Engagement
ENGL 3500	Rhetorical Traditions
ENGL 4110	Technology, Rhetoric, and Professional Communication
ENGL 4180	Seminar in Rhetoric and Writing
ENGL 4770	Seminar in Technical Communication
ENGL 4870	Internship in Business, Technical, and Professional Communication

SPCM 3120 Business and Professional Speaking

Graduate course options below require instructor approval

ENGL 5050	User Experience Architecture and Testing
ENGL 5420	Technical Editing and Publication Management
ENGL 5490	Multimedia and Interaction Design
ENGL 5860	Visual Rhetoric in Professional Communication

Designated Area of Concentration (DAC) in technical, scientific, or design field 6

Total Credits 33

Technical Communication Major Requirements

Technical Communication majors are required to have, in addition to ISUComm foundation courses (ENGL 1500 Critical Thinking and Communication and ENGL 2500 Written, Oral, Visual, and Electronic Composition), at least 33 credits in TComm (including 6 credits in a designated area of concentration). Majors transferring from other institutions must take at least 18 of their credits in TComm while in residence at Iowa State.

To graduate with a major in Technical Communication and meet the university-wide Communication Proficiency Grade Requirement (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/academics/#communicationproficiencypolicytext>), a student must have credit for ENGL 1500 Critical Thinking and Communication and earn at least a C (not C-) in ENGL 2500 Written, Oral, Visual, and Electronic Composition as well as in each of the courses taken to fulfill the program of study, including one advanced communication course.

Designated Area of Concentration Courses

The Designated Area of Concentration (DAC) is a student-designed grouping of related courses in a technical, scientific, or design field that will meet the student's professional or academic interests. Courses for the 6-credit DAC must be taken outside the English Department

and approved by the Technical Communication Program Advisor. An additional major or a minor in areas such as computer science, social science, natural science, entrepreneurial studies, design studies, engineering studies, or another technical, scientific, or design field may substitute for the DAC.

Students in all ISU majors must complete a three-credit course in U.S. Cultures and Communities and a three-credit course in International Perspectives. Check <https://www.registrar.iastate.edu/us-cultures-and-communities-and-international-perspectives> (<https://www.registrar.iastate.edu/us-cultures-and-communities-and-international-perspectives/>) for approved courses. Discuss with your advisor how the two courses that you select can be applied to your graduation plan.

LAS majors require a minimum of 120 credits, **including a minimum of 45 credits at the 3000/4000 level**. You must also complete the LAS world language requirement and career proficiency requirement.

As majors in the College of Liberal Arts and Sciences, Technical Communication students must meet College of Liberal Arts and Sciences (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/collegeofliberalartsandsciences/#lascollegerequirementstext>) and University-wide requirements (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/collegescurricula/>) for graduation in addition to those stated above for the major.

Technical Communication, B.S.

Freshman

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
ENGL 1500 (or ENGL 2500 by placement or transfer credit)	3 Social Science Choice	3
Humanities Choice	3 Natural Science Choice	3
World Language/Elective	4 Humanities Choice	3
MATH or STAT	3 World Language/Elective	4
LIB 1600	1 ENGL 2500 (if not in Fall); or ENGL 3100	3
ENGL 2140	3	
	17	16

Sophomore

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
ENGL 3100, 3130, or 2500	3 Technical/Scientific/Design Course	3
Social Science Choice	3 ENGL 3140	3
U.S. Cultures and Communities Choice	3 ENGL 3130, 3100, or TComm Elective	3
Natural Science Choice	3 Humanities Choice or elective	3

Elective/Minor	3 TComm Elective/Minor	3
LAS 2030	1 Natural Science Choice	2
	16	17

Junior

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
TComm Choice: ENG 4160, 4770, or other 4000-level TComm course	3 ENGL 4150	3
Elective/Minor	3 Minor	3
International Perspectives Choice	3 TComm Elective from List (ENGL 3000+)	3
Humanities Choice	3 Technical/Scientific/Design Course	3
Social Science Choice	3 Electives	3
	15	15

Senior

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
Technical/Scientific/Design Course	3 ENGL 4870 (recommended)	3
TComm Elective from List – ENGL 4000+	9 TComm Elective from List – ENGL 4000+	3
Electives/Minor	3 Electives or Minor	6
	15	12

Students may double-count some courses to complete the degree requirements in 120 credits.

Technical Communication Minor Requirements

The department offers a minor in Technical Communication, which students may earn by completing the following:

ENGL 3140	Technical Communication	3
Choose 4:		12
ENGL 2140	Introduction to Technical Communication	
ENGL 3020	Business Communication	
ENGL 3090	Proposal and Report Writing	
ENGL 3100	Rhetorical Analysis	
ENGL 3120	Communicating Science and Public Engagement	
ENGL 3130	Rhetorical Website Design	
or with the appropriate prerequisites		
ENGL 4110	Technology, Rhetoric, and Professional Communication	
ENGL 4150	Business and Technical Editing	
ENGL 4160	Visual Aspects of Business and Technical Communication	

ENGL 4770	Seminar in Technical Communication
ENGL 5290	Content Management
ENGL 5420	Technical Editing and Publication Management
ENGL 5490	Multimedia and Interaction Design
Total Credits	15

The minor requires 15 credits as listed above; at least 9 credits must be numbered 2000 level or above, of which at least 6 credits are in courses numbered 3000 or above. The minor must include at least 3 credits that are not used to meet any other department, college, or university requirement.

Students must earn a grade of C (not C-) or higher in each course taken in the minor. The minor must include at least 3 credits that are not used to meet any other department, college, or university requirement. Students may design their minor programs around their own interests but are encouraged to work with the Technical Communication Program Advisor.

The Technical Communication Undergraduate Minor is an LAS Minor. In addition to University policies governing minors (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/academics/#degreeplanningtext>), LAS minors require at least 6 credits in courses numbered 3000 and above, with a grade of C or higher.

Note: Students should check the ISU catalog to be sure that they meet prerequisites if they intend to register for 4000+ courses.